

EVICTIION PROCESS — VA

For: John Doe

Understanding the process reduces fear and helps you prepare. This is a general timeline — your specific dates are on your summons.

1. Notice *(5-30 days)*

Landlord serves pay-or-quit (5 days) or termination notice (30 days).

2. Summons for Unlawful Detainer *(After notice)*

You are served with court papers including a return date.

3. File Grounds of Defense *(By return date)*

YOU ARE HERE. You must appear on the return date and file DC-442 Grounds of Defense.

4. Trial *(Return date or later)*

Judge hears case. VA courts move quickly — often heard on the first appearance.

5. Judgment *(Day of trial)*

If you lose, judge issues judgment. You have 10 days to appeal.

6. Writ of Possession *(10+ days after judgment)*

Sheriff posts notice and executes eviction.

IMPORTANT: This timeline is a general guide. Your specific deadlines and procedures depend on your state, county, and case type. Read your summons carefully. If you do not understand something, ask the court clerk or a legal aid attorney.

IMPORTANT: This document is provided for informational purposes only. It is not legal advice. If you need legal advice, contact a licensed attorney.
You are responsible for your own case and what you say in court.